



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Analyzer Data Validation

Application Maintenance Site Management Component Rebuild Safety MARC Management

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1.0 Introduction

This Best Practice deals with MARC Management. The ability to accurately forecast the financial health of a MARC throughout its term, especially where CGM is providing support through a Risk Partnering/Sharing agreement, is reliant on accurate Analyzer application setup as well as regular interfacing of accurate operational and financial data into Analyzer.

The Analyzer Data Validation Process is made up of a Master Process, which includes the initial application setup process as well as the revised data file process. This Master Process is then broken down into detailed sub-processes for each of the major Master Process steps.

Goal: Accurate forecasting of MARC financial health using Analyzer.

Objectives: Identify and communicate Analyzer setup and data file inaccuracies to the applicable Dealer for correction.

Scope: Detection of Analyzer data inaccuracies leading to inaccurate forecasting. Applies to any Analyzer data file used by Cat and/or Dealer personnel.

2.0 Best Practice Description

Currently there is not a consistent process being used by CGM and Dealers. Dealers focus on known areas that consistently create data inaccuracies and make the necessary corrections. Dealers then forward the data to CGM. It is then up to CGM to search through the data in no set order or process in an attempt to ensure any additional data inaccuracies are identified and eventually corrected.

The Analyzer Data Validation Process, included in the Attachments Tab of this file ([ALZ Global Validation Process.vsd](#)), eliminates the guesswork as to where one should look for potential data inaccuracies. It provides the roadmap necessary to ensure each major area of Analyzer data is reviewed and scrutinized before the data is considered accurate. If any issues or questions arise during the process, notes are taken and then communicated to the appropriate Dealer personnel for corrective action.

3.0 Implementation Steps

1. Communicate process to the MARC supervisor for review and suggestions. Make necessary revisions.
2. Communicate process to the Regional MARC Consultants (RMCs) for review and suggestions. Make necessary revisions.
3. Pilot process within CGM and one Dealer. Make necessary revisions.
4. Implement process within CGM, including the RMCs.
5. Deploy process globally to receptive Dealers.

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4.0 Benefits

The identification and communication of Analyzer data inaccuracies is key to making accurate MARC financial health forecasts using Analyzer.

- Time & Cost:

- o Implementing this process ensures the timely delivery of accurate Analyzer data required to for operational and financial decisions to be made by Dealers and CGM. For contracts with a RP/RS agreement, an audit, primarily of Analyzer data, performed by CGM is required before any settlement can take place. Ensuring accurate Analyzer data through this process will greatly reduce the time required to prepare for and perform such audits. With the growing number of MARCs, it is imperative to have a globally consistent process to reduce the time required to review the data to ensure timely reporting of results using the same amount of resources.

- Quality:

- o CGM:
 - Increased accuracy of support accruals/budgeting
 - Reduced financial risk by identifying incorrect Analyzer usage and amending inaccurate data
 - Increased accuracy of support payments
- o Dealer
 - Increased accuracy of accruals/budgeting
 - Ability to react to operational issues that are having a negative financial impact
 - Ability to replicate operational practices that are having a positive financial impact

5.0 Resources Required

Critical Assumption: Analyzer has been successfully implemented and is currently being used.

- Facilities: N/A
- Tools: N/A
- Support Equipment: N/A
- Labor: Having trained Analyzer users is critical to the success of this process.
- Users should have received some form of basic Analyzer training either internally or through Caterpillar.
- In addition, users should have a basic understanding of Microsoft Access (MS Access 2000 Level 1 & 2).
- Operations and Financial resources within the Dealership must be accessible to the user.

6.0 Supporting Attachments

Refer to ALZ [Analyzer Global Validation Process.vsd](#) – Microsoft Visio file (zipped), located in the “Attachments” Tab of this pdf file.

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7.0 Related Best Practices

None applicable

8.0 Acknowledgements

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